JIAER LIU

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Finance, Industrial Organization, Market Design

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles — *Los Angeles, USA*
Ph.D. in Economics — Expected 2027
Committee: Pierre-Olivier Weill (Chair), John Asker, Andrew Atkeson, Martin Hackmann, and Lee Ohanian

Tsinghua University — *Beijing, China*
B.A. in Economics and Finance — 2021

WORKING PAPERS

"Design of US Treasury Secondary Market: Venue Sorting, Competing Mechanisms, and Allocative Efficiency"

Job Market Paper | *PDF* | *Selected for the Poster Session at the Macro Finance Research (MFR) Summer Session for Young Scholars, Becker Friedman Institute, University of Chicago*

Abstract: Is the current fragmented structure of the U.S. Treasury secondary market, in which centralized and decentralized venues coexist, optimal? This paper develops a venue-choice model to study allocative efficiency under current and alternative market structures as aggregate risk varies. Venues differ in their pricing and matching mechanisms, and agents sort across venues based on the tradeoff between execution certainty and transaction costs. When aggregate risk is low, gains from trade are primarily realized through trading in the centralized venue, the central limit order book, which mitigates inefficiencies associated with search frictions in the decentralized over-the-counter venue. However, as aggregate risk increases, adverse selection intensifies for limit orders, discouraging limit-order submission and reducing order book depth, while agents substitute toward decentralized over-the-counter trading and recover gains from trade that would otherwise be lost. Quantifying the model using transaction-level U.S. Treasury data, this paper finds that the current hybrid market structure achieves 87 percent of the first-best allocation, outperforming both over-the-counter-only and fully centralized market structures. These findings rationalize the current fragmented market.

"Venue Participation and Transaction Cost: Evidence from China Government Bonds Market"

with Shuo Liu | *Available on SSRN* | *Selected for presentation at the 26th China Economics Annual Conference (CEAC) and the 2026 Chinese Economists Society (CES) China Annual Conference*

Abstract: This paper examines trading activity and transaction cost differences across the Over-the-Counter (OTC) and Central Limit Order Book (CLOB) venues in the China government bonds market. Using novel trade-level data and matching method, we estimate that CLOB lowers transaction costs by 0.66 basis points relative to OTC, highlighting efficiency gains from the centralized trading mechanism. We also document selection in venue participation: CLOB disproportionately facilitates core traders, standardized orders, and newly issued bonds, indicating potential redistributional effects. Despite CLOB's cost advantage, OTC remains active due to complementary benefits, including mitigating information leakage, designating counterparties, and facilitating bond holding position rebalancing.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Price Schedules and the Transmission of Central Bank Purchases"

PRESENTATIONS

2026: Macro Finance Research (MFR) Summer Session for Young Scholars, Poster Session (UChicago, BFI); Chinese Economists Society (CES) China Annual Conference (SWUFE)*.

2025: Summer Finance Workshop (Tsinghua)*; Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics, macroeconomics session (UCLA).

* Presented by coauthor.

HONORS, AWARDS, FUNDS

Dissertation Completion Fellowship (with stipend), UCLA	2026–2027
Lewis L. Clarke Data Purchase and Data Collection Award (with grant), UCLA	2026
Minoru Kobayashi China Economic Research Fund	2025–
Tuition Grant, Graduate Division Award, UCLA	2021–2023

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Macroeconomic Theory (Econ 102, undergraduate upper-division) — Fall 2025, Winter 2026
Teaching Assistant, UCLA. Overall teaching evaluation: 7.65/9.

REFERENCES

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